



Tournament in Berlin, followed by a European tour across Belgium, Germany, and the Netherlands before the Sultan of Johor Cup. Since then, the squad has undergone intensive training at its SAI Bengaluru camp, which included practice matches against the senior team.

The six-nation event in Malaysia

exposed a clear concern: Penalty Corner conversion. Across seven matches, India managed only eight goals from 53 attempts. While ground conditions have been discussed at length, the issue remains significant heading into the World Cup.

"We have addressed the issue in



INDIAN SQUAD

Goalkeepers

Bikramjit Singh, Princedee Singh

Defenders

Rohit (c), Talem Priyobarta, Anmol Ekka, Amir Ali, Sunil Palakshappa Bennur, Shardanand Tiwari

Midfielders

Ankit Pal, Thounaojam Ingalemba Luwang, Adrohit Ekka, Rosan Kujur, Manmeet Singh, Gurjot Singh

Forwards

Arshdeep Singh, Sourabh Anand Kushwaha, Ajeet Yadav, Dilraj Singh

Reserve players

Ravneet Singh, Rohit Kullu

the camp. We have put extra emphasis on both PC and PC defence. We have good drag flickers, who are flicking 200-300 a day. They have gained experience from the tournament and are now better equipped," said Sreejesh.

Skipper Rohit will be central during short corners. The drag flick specialist was India's top scorer in the previous edition (3), and in Hundal's absence, the Chandigarh-born defender is determined to lead from the front. "We are very excited to play in front of our people. This is a big tournament, and we understand its importance. We have trained hard for the last two years, and now it is all about executing those during matches," said Rohit.

As Sreejesh takes on his first major coaching assignment, he will inevitably draw attention. His focus, however, lies beyond immediate headlines. He views this campaign as part of a larger effort to secure the future of Indian hockey.

The four-time Olympian emphasised that while winning remains the primary goal, the tournament also serves as a platform to prepare players for the long road ahead.

"One thing I always tell the boys is to dream big. They will not be playing in the junior team forever. Their dream should be to play in Los Angeles 2028 or Brisbane 2032. It is